DEPARTURE

By Masumi Saito and An-Ting

Photo credit: Guy Wigmore

Departure: a music and dance performance exploring the themes of death, nature, and the spirit

by Movement Artist Masumi Saito & Composer/Musician An-Ting

Why do cultures have long-established funeral traditions? And, what can we learn about death - and life - from these rituals? In *Departure*, Masumi Saito and An-Ting re-create a funeral ceremony based on their East Asian traditions as a performance; inviting the audience to join in a contemplative space.

Our collaboration intertwines movement and live music to create an emotionally resonant performance, breaking the silence around death. The performance takes the audience into the world of a traditional funeral, exploring the profound memories shared between the living and the deceased, while journeying into an imagined supernatural realm beyond death.

The performance evokes a sense of connection to a greater power beyond ourselves, creating a trance-like experience that transports people to a different level of consciousness.

Supported by the Arts Council England, Departure is developed through different R&D stages at the SEEN Festival (Nouveau Riche, Broadway Theatre) and Snape Residency (Britten Pear Arts). The production has been touring since November 2025.

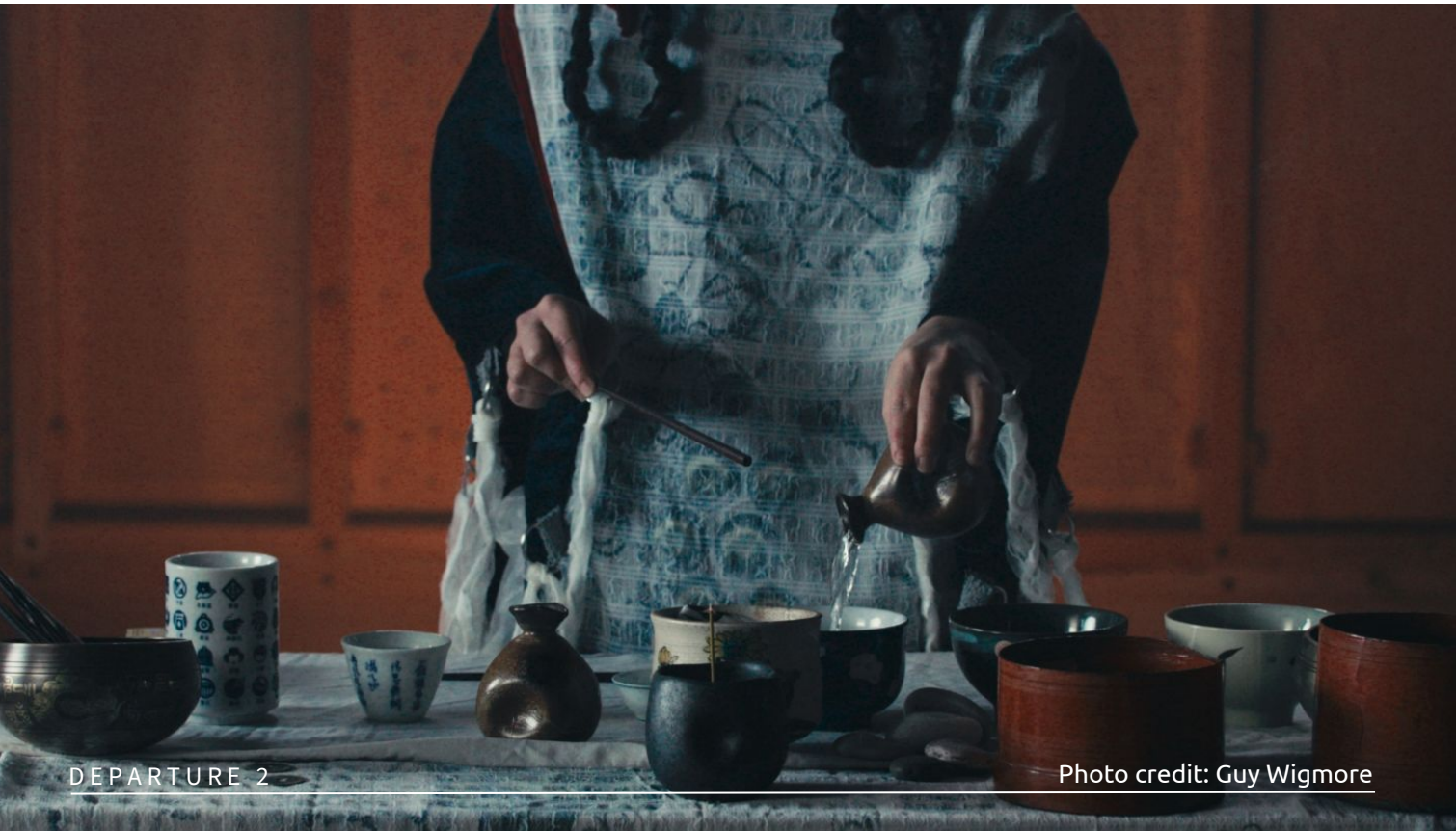

Photo credit: Guy Wigmore

POST-SHOW DISCUSSION

A conversation about death, funeral practices, natures, and spirits - Creating a space for contemplating life together by exploring death

There is a default post-show discussion followed by every performance where Masumi and An-Ting invite the audience to join a conversation about death, ritual and spirit.

Masumi and An-Ting take inspiration from Death Cafe and offer a space where people can share their experiences about how traditions and rituals can impact the grief process. What can we learn about death - and life - from these rituals, and by coming together as a community?

The performance runs for 45 minutes. Followed by a short break (suggested length 5-10 minutes), the post-show discussion will last for 30 minutes.

REVIEWS AND QUOTES

> "Departure is a haunting, thoughtfully made work that honours the fact that grief often lives beyond reasonable articulation, and that sometimes the body can speak when words will not."
> STAGETALK (4/5)

> "It was totally engrossing and I found myself transfixed visually and aurally and I definitely came away having learned a lot more about other cultures, rituals which felt really enriching."
> BETH BYRNE (CREATIVE DIRECTOR, WARWICK ARTS CENTRE)

> "I really enjoyed the show and particularly loved the embedded post show Q&A. The blend of live music, movement, striking visuals and the cultural exchange was incredibly strong and really exciting to see in such an intimate space. "
> JODIE PAGET (ASSISTANT PRODUCER, THEATRE ROYAL PLYMOUTH)

> "I've been thinking about all the transitions in my life left incomplete because the end wasn't grieved, as such rituals have been lost in my culture. I received your performance as a gift for which I longed but had no place to experience."
> AUDIENCE MEMBER

Photo credit: Devika Bilimoria

MARKETING

Departure is designed to appeal to contemporary music, performance and dance audiences. With Masumi and An-Ting actively growing their respective followings in these fields, we will provide high-quality images and videos to support promotion efforts.

The production offers a unique angle for engaging audience who is interested in the particular topic, for example Death Café groups. Without any language barrier, the show is accessible for any background sand age groups. We will collaborate closely with the venue's marketing team to maximise reach and attract a diverse audience.

@antingpig / @hello_masumisaito

VIDEO TRAILER

Trailer 1 - Live Music
Trailer 2 - Dance
Behind-The-Scenes 1 (Theme)
Behind-The-Scenes 2 (Music)

Full-length footage available upon request.

Photo credit: Guy Wigmore

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MOVEMENT ARTIST/ MASUMI SAITO

Masumi Saito is a movement artist, mother, and choreographer at Theo Adams Company. She creates film works and live performances influenced by nature, spirits, and the Japanese way of being. She has presented her work at renowned venues worldwide, including HOME Manchester, ICA, Jerwood Space, and Kanazawa 21st Century Museum. The Nakanojo Biennale in Japan has commissioned her five times.

At the heart of her creative exploration lies a profound inquiry into the relationship between self and surroundings. She delves into the depths of inner being with grace and authenticity, inviting audiences on a journey of introspection and self-discovery.

COMPOSER, MUSICIAN/ AN-TING 安婷

An-Ting is a musician, composer and multi disciplinary artist. She has led productions including Lost Communications (File Festival - Brazil, N&N Festival, Immersive Arts), HOME X (nominated for UK Theatre Awards, Barbican, Oxford Contemporary Music, Theatre Royal York, Cambridge Junction), CAN X Two Temple Place: Digital Exhibition and Immersive Performance (Arts Council England's Digital Culture Award - Storytelling), *Lao Can Impression* (Purcell Room, National Theater Taiwan), *Bats and Beats* (Southbank's Soundstate Festival, Shanghai tour).

Between 2018 and 2023, she led the National Portfolio Organisation Kakilang, supporting new works by East and Southeast Asian artists. She was awarded as a 2024 Sound Generator Artist by Sound UK, and is currently a research fellow at the Norwich University of Arts.

PAST/ CURRENT TOURING VENUES

13. 06. 24	Broadway Theatre Catford
07. 12. 24	Snape Residency
04. 11. 25	Warwick Arts Centre
09. 11. 25	Norwich Arts Centre
15. 11. 25	The Cut Halesworth
18-22. 11. 25	Bristol Old Vic
03. 12. 25	Colchester Arts Centre
21. 12. 25	IKLECTIK (London)
8-9. 05. 26	York Theatre Royal
16. 06. 26	Aldeburgh Festival

Photo credit: Sol Denker

TECHNICAL REQUIREMENT

Departure stage is formed by an altar table with the sound equipment, two performers with four costumes and a minimum playing area of 5m x 5m. It can be presented end-on or thrust.

The venue will provide a minimum of two technicians, one for lighting and one for sound. The show require a basic lighting rig and a minimum of a stereo PA system. Please refer to the tech rider for more details.

Running time: 45 minutes, with 30-minute post-show conversation.

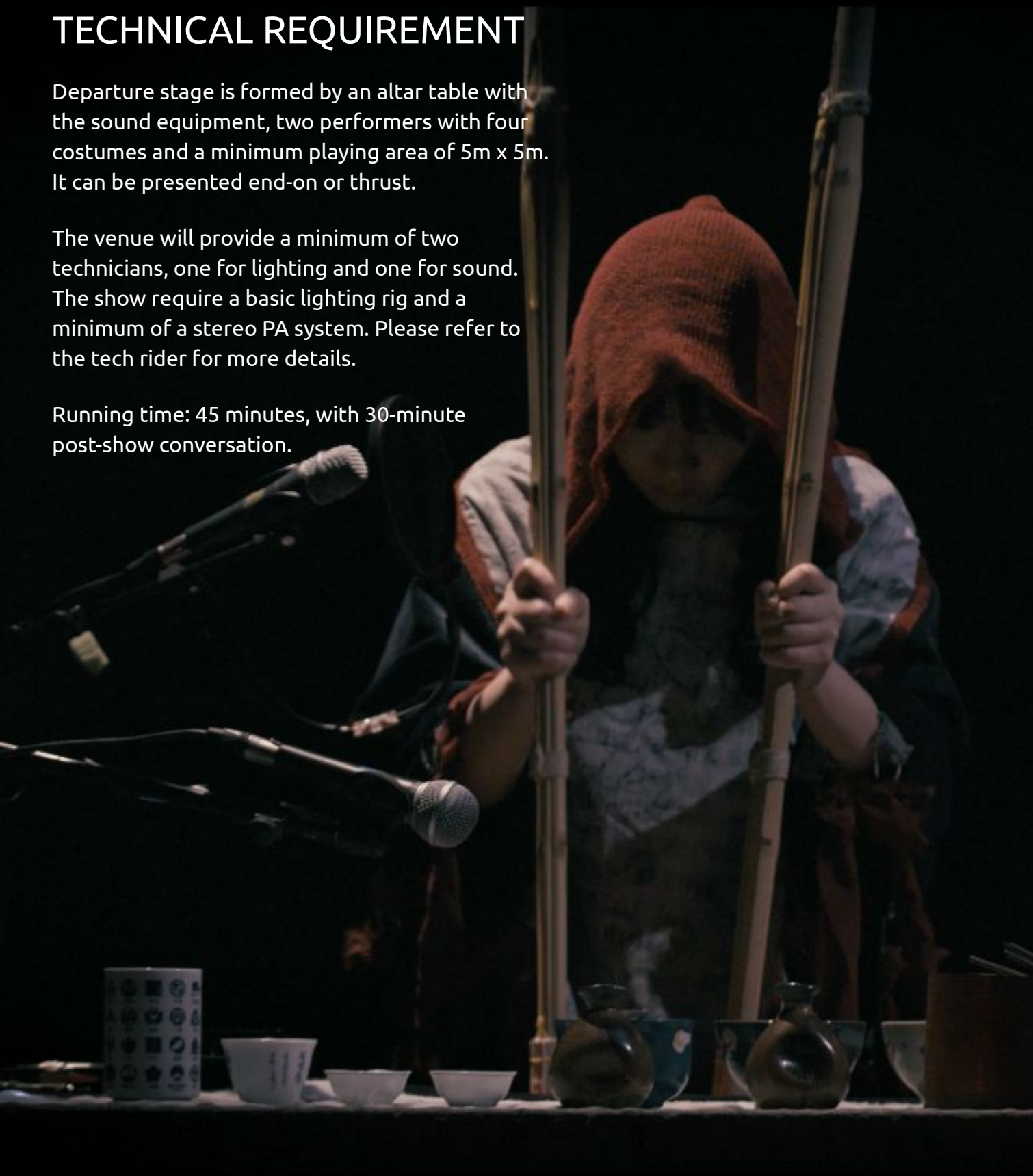

Photo credit: Sol Denker

CREDIT

Departure by Masumi Saito and An-Ting
Costume Design: Sophie Wang
Lighting Design: Nao Nagai
Producer: Yingnan Chu
Supported by Arts Council England, Britten Pears Arts, Nouveau Riche, Lewisham Council and Broadway Theatre

Photo credit: Guy Wigmore